



Nimble
A fast, tactical TTRPG

ADVENTURING COMPANIONS

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ADVENTURING COMPANIONS

Adventuring Companions are NPCs that join the party, sometimes permanently, sometimes temporarily as it suits the story. Companions are controlled by the GM outside of combat, and they are controlled by the heroes while in combat. They play simply like a monster's stat block, but with added survivability and utility of a hero.

HOW COMPANIONS WORK

- **Actions.** Adventuring Companions act in combat similar to monsters. Instead of 3 actions like heroes, they simply perform whatever their stat block says. Any hero can decide when they take their action in a round (the party should generally agree though).
- **Initiative.** Companions don't roll initiative, they simply move on their first turn in combat.
- **Saves.** Companions roll their saves with a flat d20 roll. Some may have advantaged and disadvantaged saves as heroes do.
- **Death & Dying.** While Dying, Their actions are not limited nor do they need to make STR saves to perform actions; however, taking too many wounds may cause them to permanently die, so be careful!
- **Resting.** Companions regain HP equal to their level during a Field Rest.
- **Leveling up.** Companions level up when heroes do.

WHEN TO USE A COMPANION

- **Solo or Small groups.** If you are playing with a solo hero (or duo) and a GM, using a Companion can maintain the teamwork and

tactical feel of playing with a larger group. It also helps to maintain the expected balance of Solo/Legendary monster encounters.

- **Adoption.** If your party adopts a pet or makes a good friend. Consider adding it as a companion, though it is recommended to use no more than ONE Adventuring Companion at a time in a party.
- **Quest Reward.** An Adventuring Companion (whether permanent or temporary) could make for a fantastic quest reward for the party as well!

ENCOUNTER BALANCE

Regular combat encounters will be slightly more easy with an Adventuring Companion (but not as easy as if an additional hero were present), consider increasing the difficulty one step to compensate (easy » medium » hard » deadly). For solo or legendary encounters, there is no need to make any changes.

GM Note. *Adventuring Companions are there to help the heroes shine, they are NOT heroes themselves. Be careful not to let them lead, overtake, or outshine the heroes. They should look up to and follow the heroes! Companions can aid sometimes when asked, but they will generally defer to the heroes on which course of action to take ("That's above my paygrade" or "I'm just here to crack some skulls" or "Your wisdom leads us, I will follow").*

Companions should add richness to the story, not solve all the heroes' problems. Allow Companions to throw a wrinkle in the story: they may require payment (in money, food, recognition), they may have their own foibles and fears ("I'm NOT attacking that spider!"), they may or may not be reliable. They may come with their own quests, problems, and goals. But make sure it serves the existing story, rather than replacing it!



Small Kobold Adventuring Companion, The Cheat
Stabs, the Somewhat Reliable

5/LVL

DEX+

Companion. Can Interpose for friends (but you'll never hear the end of it!)
Pocket Sand! (1/encounter) force an adjacent enemy to reroll an attack with disadvantage.

ACTIONS: Each turn, move 6 then choose 1:

- **Stab!** 1d4 (Advantage VS Distracted targets). On Crit: +LVL damage (instead of rolling additional dice)
- **Shadowstep.** "Teleport" behind an creature you can see, (DC 10 WIL save or Frightened 1 turn).

Dying: See Ya! When Stabs drops to 0 HP, he can turn Invisible until the end of his next turn.

WOUNDS ○ ○ ○ ○ ○





Human Adventuring Companion, Shepherd

Grace, Lightbearer

6/LVL

WIL+

Companion. Can Interpose for friends ("Here when you need me!").
The Light Bless You! (1/encounter) After an ally gains a Wound, heal them 2xLVL HP.

ACTIONS: Each turn, move 6 then choose 1:

- **Radiant Strike.** (Reach 4) 1d6 (ignoring armor), does not miss. +2 damage every 5 levels.
- **Sacred Guidance.** (Reach 2) give an ally advantage on their next attack. +1 Reach every 5 levels.

Dying: Spirit of Vengeance. (1/ encounter) When Grace drops to 0 HP, move 3 then deal 10 damage to all enemies within Reach 3 (ignoring armor). +2 damage every 5 levels.

WOUNDS

